



Now let's look at a tougher case.

*My Division.* My body is fatally injured, as are the brains of my two brothers. My brain is divided, and each half is successfully transplanted into the body of one of my brothers. Each of the resulting people believes that he is me, seems to remember living my life, has my character, and is in every other way psychologically continuous with me. And he has a body that is very like mine.

Let's call the resulting people *Lefty* and *Righty*. Then we seem to have four options:

- (1) You survive as A.
- (2) You survive as B.
- (3) You survive as both A and B.
- (4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)–(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with

option (4): you do not survive.

But this looks bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the right kinds of connections to both A and B.

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemisphere Transplant but not My  
Division.



Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is required for your survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

But here is an odd consequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant operation. Next to you on another hospital bed is a body into whom the other hemisphere was transplanted.

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

You think that you know that you are the person you remember being. But, if that other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you remember being.

But how could your identity — who you are — depend on what happens with that other body?

This is an argument against the idea that we can save the psychological theory of survival by adding on a non-branching clause. Intuitively, the idea is that whether you are the same person as  $X$  depends **only** on relations between you and  $X$  — it can't possibly depend on relations to some other thing!

We can turn this into an argument against the psychological theory:

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false, because the psychological connections to Marsy and Venusy are branching connections.

- (1) If some version of the psychological theory of survival is true, it must be a ‘non-branching’ theory.
  - (2) Whether I am the same person as X depends only on relations between me and X.
  - (3) No ‘non-branching’ theory can be true. (2)
- 

(C) The psychological theory of survival is false.



# THE NO-NON-BRANCHING ARGUMENT

We've seen that My Division can be used to make trouble for materialist and  
psychological theories of survival.

What should the believer in soul say about this kind of case?

At first glance, the believer in souls might seem to have a much easier time than other views. After all, according to the believer in souls, survival is a matter of the survival of an immaterial soul. And immaterial souls (unlike brains) cannot be split into two.

But My Division can still be used to pose a challenge for the believer in souls. It seems that the believer in souls has two options:

In My Division, the  
psychophysical laws  
imply that your soul  
gets connected to  
neither of the resulting  
bodies, so that neither  
Lefty nor Righty is you.

Could we say instead that in this case one of Lefty or Righty would be you? Perhaps in this kind of case the psychophysical laws randomly connect the soul to one of the two hemispheres.

But suppose that you are Lefty, and you are wondering whether you are the same person as the person whose body was fatally injured. You know that Righty is wondering the same thing. At most one of you is the person you seem to remember being. Will you ever be able to discover who really is that person?



In My Division,  
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of Lefty or  
Righty (but not  
both).

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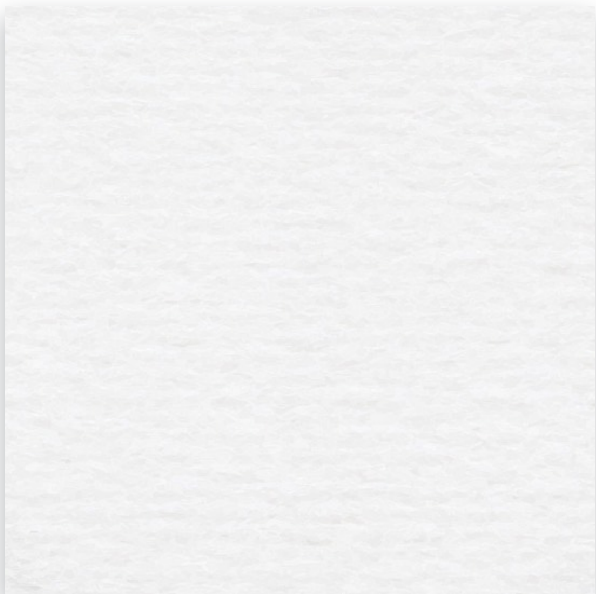
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